

John Hanacek

PRODUCT DESIGN ENGINEER · AI, WEB, 3D & XR · 14 YEARS

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SUMMARY

Product design engineer across AI, web, 3D and XR. Shipped Nanome 2's XR molecular design tool to pharma customers and an AR situational-awareness HUD for first responders. Built a portfolio site whose search runs a language model in the browser. Founding design for early-stage teams through JHDesign LLC. Prototypes in JavaScript, Three.js, WebGPU and Unity.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Design Engineer · JHDesign LLC 2024–Present · San Diego / remote

- OpenProse (2026): founding design in two months. Brand, five logo directions, 137 homepage approaches as live pages across 471 commits, one canonical style.
- Muse.bio (2024, 2026): user-journey and personas workshops. Built a Claude Code + Figma MCP system that turns workshop output into structured results. Handed off.
- JH Coaching OS: shipped an AI coaching product (agent, materials, context docs, dashboard). Clients leave with a chief-of-staff agent around their own work, or the skills to build software.

Lead XR Product Designer · Nanome Inc. 2022–2024 · San Diego

- Led product design for Nanome 2 on Meta Quest, the companion web portal and the MARA AI assistant. All shipped. Supervised the visionOS beta.
- Ran 24 alpha and beta sessions with scientists at Pfizer, Novartis and academic labs. Coded the feedback into bugs, questions, evidence and patterns.
- Replaced teleport navigation with Spotlight/Follow: labeled cursors and a shared, non-rivalrous molecule. A pillar of Nanome 2.

Immersive UI/UX Designer · BadVR, Inc. 2021–2022 · Los Angeles / remote

- Designed the AROC situational-awareness AR HUD and its modular layout grid, with hand tracking on Meta Quest and HoloLens 2. Shipped.
- Insurance damage-assessment demo over a simulated New York for Munich Re: design, recorded demo content, manuals.

Founding CEO/CTO, Co-Founder · AvatarMEDIC, Inc. 2019–2021 · San Francisco / San Diego

- Co-founded a medtech startup for remote trauma intervention through XR telepresence and robotics. Led strategy, pitching, concept and engineering direction. Founder Institute SF (2020).
- Built the Unity robot demo, visual design, animatics and composites. The digital-twin robotic medical assistant won the Aerospace Medical Association's R&D Innovation Award (2022).

UI/UX Design Lead · Collaborate.org 2015–2018 · Remote (hourly)

- Product design and interactive mockups, remote.

Graduate Associate · CNDLS, Georgetown University 2014–2015 · Washington, DC

- Pedagogical tools. Co-authored EDULEARN15 research on the spread of technology-enhanced teaching.

Designer, Photographer, Product Maker · Independent practice (JHphotography, JHDesign) 2012–2024 · San Diego

- Blok Dok (2013): designed, made and sold a wooden iPhone dock, with packaging, labels, instructions and photography.

Earlier: Photographer, Qualcomm Institute (Calit2) and UCSD Guardian; Ocean Lifeguard, California State Parks (2007–2012)

EDUCATION

MA, Communication, Culture & Technology · Georgetown University 2014–2016

Thesis: "As We May Sketch" · "Most Meta", voted by peers (2016)

BA, Political Science / International Relations; minor in Neuroscience · UC San Diego 2008–2012

SKILLS

Design & research: User research, usability testing, qualitative coding, 3D interaction, design systems, brand, workshops, PRDs. Figma · FigJam · Blender · Unity / C# · ShapesXR · Adobe Creative Suite

Code: JavaScript · TypeScript · React · HTML / CSS · Three.js · WebGL / GLSL · WebGPU · Node.js · Playwright · Git

AI & agentic: Context engineering, agent orchestration, tool-use design, RAG, conversational UX. Claude Code · OpenCode · Hermes Agent · LM Studio · Ollama · MCP (Blender, Figma)

XR & robotics: Digital twins, teleoperation, 3D scanning. Meta Quest · HoloLens 2 · Magic Leap One · visionOS

AWARDS

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">2022 AsMA R&D Innovation Award: XR digital-twin robot control2021 NIST CHARIoT Challenge, Phase 2 winner: A1R augmented first responder | <ul style="list-style-type: none">2020 Microsoft Reactor Hackathon winner: HoloTRIAGE on HoloLens 22020 Founder Institute San Francisco graduate2019 AT&T 5G Hackathon winner: SAR 5G on Magic Leap One | <ul style="list-style-type: none">2016 "Most Meta", Georgetown CCT, voted by peers2014 Kevin Kelly's Technium future-vision challenge winner |
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TALKS & WRITING

AWE USA 2024 Lightning Round · XRDC 2024 mentor · contributor, *Spatial Design: Breaking the 2D Paradigm* (2024) · EDULEARN15 paper · Atlantic Council essays on answer engines (2014)

